From an Unwritten Routine to a Support Map

An unhurried nine-step plan for looking at your mother's safety and support, with a line for who takes each step and when.

The goal: the routine that keeps your mother's week running is on paper, with who helps, who could cover, and a short list of the things you'd like a professional to hear about.

There's no clock on this. Share the list, put a name next to each step, add a date only where a date helps, and tick each one when it's done.

ACTION	WHO	BY WHEN	DONE
1. Write out an ordinary week of your mother's help: who is there on which day, and the times when she is on her own. Ask her to check it.			
2. Write down anything you've seen about her balance or how she gets around, as what you saw, where and when.			
3. Write down anything you've noticed about how her medications go, for her doctor or pharmacist to review. Change nothing.			
4. Write down anything around the house that you've seen or she has mentioned, as one specific thing in one specific place.			
5. Ask each person who helps how it is going on their end and whether their day still suits them. Write the answer as they give it.			
6. Note any instructions a professional has already given her, and where they are written down.			
7. Next to each helper, write who could cover for a week. Where nobody has been asked, write "nobody yet."			
8. Next to each concern and open question, write which professional it goes to: her doctor, her pharmacist or your care consultant.			
9. Put a family member's name beside each item to follow up, and agree on what would bring you back to this page.			

You're done when

A support map, your backup questions and a list for the professionals all exist on paper, and the family has agreed on a reason to look at them again: a date, or a change in someone's work, home or health. The review of that list, and any change to your mother's routine, isn't on this plan. That part belongs to her and to the professionals who know her.

If a step stalls

- “Nobody yet” and “don't know” are finished lines. Don't fill one with a guess, or with the name of someone who hasn't been asked.
- If your mother would rather not go through it today, leave it for another visit. It's her week.
- If one step is stuck, go on to the next and come back. The order helps, and none of it is due by a date.

What this plan doesn't do

It organizes the family's part. Finishing it doesn't certify that your mother or her home is safe, and it doesn't authorize any change to her care or her medications. It doesn't stand in for the professional review it gets you ready for.

Ready for the next step?

You've taken the routine out of everyone's heads and put it on paper, a step at a time. The care interview goes through your mother's situation area by area with you, so the map sits inside a fuller picture, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›